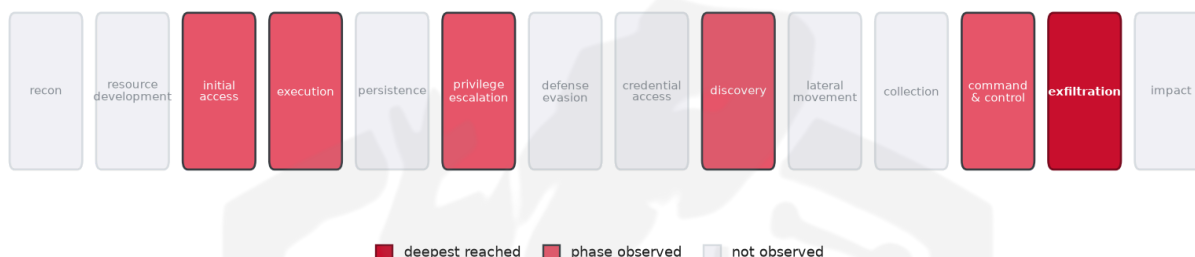


THREAT REPORT: UNC3569 DEPLOYS GRAYRABBIT ONE-CLICK BACKDOOR VIA SPEARPHISHING LINKS

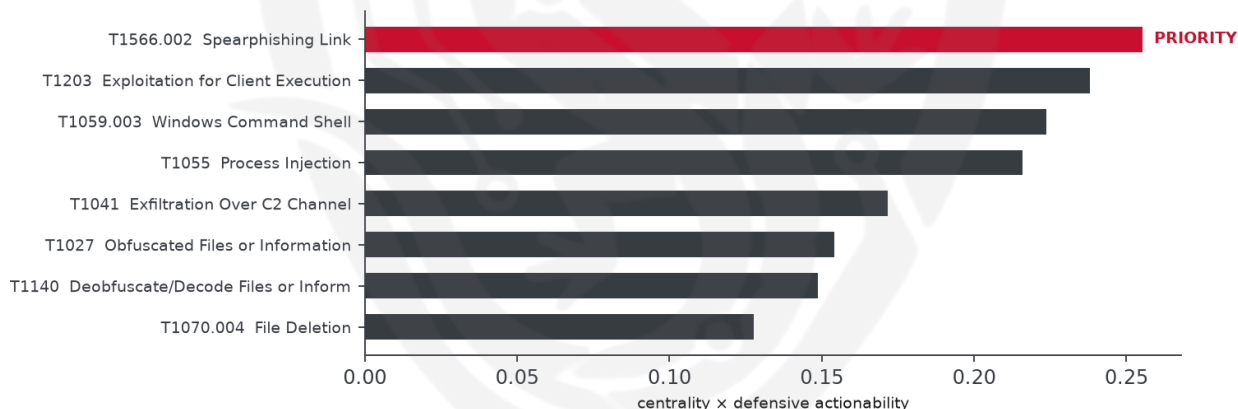
Visual Summary

Kill-Chain Reach — Critical (deepest phase reached: exfiltration)



How far down the attack chain this campaign reached; deepest phase in crimson.

Defensive Chokepoint — why this control is the priority



The control that most disrupts the attack (priority in crimson).

Summary

The source attributes this activity to UNC3569, which leverages the GrayRabbit and RabbitFur malware families to exploit CVE-2026-51990. The campaign targets organizations in the government, education, technology, and finance sectors, though the specific country of focus is not disclosed. Priority defensive actions include hardening against social-engineering delivery across email, links, and voice/callback lures, sandboxing attachments, rewriting links, blocking macro-enabled Office documents from the internet zone, user training, a report-phish button, phishing-resistant MFA, and promptly patching CVE-2026-51990.

Threat Overview

UNC3569 operates the GrayRabbit and RabbitFur malware families and exploits the client-execution vulnerability CVE-2026-51990 (also referencing CVE-2021-38003). The threat actor focuses on victims in

the government, education, technology, and finance sectors, with no concrete country identified.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed attack chain begins with a spearphishing link (T1566.002) that directs the victim to a malicious payload. The payload exploits CVE-2026-51990 for client execution (T1203), then uses techniques such as process injection (T1055), DLL injection (T1055.001), system information discovery (T1082), and exfiltration over the C2 channel (T1041) to achieve its objectives.

Priority technique: T1566.002 Spearphishing Link

Concrete control: Harden against social-engineering delivery across email, links and voice/callback lures: attachment sandboxing and link rewriting, block macro-enabled Office docs from the internet zone, train users to verify unexpected requests out-of-band, deploy a report-phish button, and enforce phishing-resistant MFA. In parallel, patch CVE-2026-51990 on all affected systems.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The enrichment data reports no observable hosting providers or ASNs associated with this activity. AbuseIPDB did not flag any indicators with a confidence level of 80 % or higher, and abuse.ch has not corroborated any of the malware families.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1033 System Owner/User Discovery
- T1132.001 Standard Encoding
- T1129 Shared Modules
- T1573.001 Symmetric Cryptography
- T1497.001 System Checks
- T1566.002 Spearphishing Link
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1041 Exfiltration Over C2 Channel
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1203 Exploitation for Client Execution
- T1059.003 Windows Command Shell
- T1070.004 File Deletion
- T1027.002 Software Packing
- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1574.002 Hijack Execution Flow

- T1204.001 Malicious Link
- T1055.001 Dynamic-link Library Injection

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1566.002 Spearphishing Link (centrality 0.2553).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 0.968, reaches exfiltration).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4886; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Tropic Trooper	0.4886
Evilnum	0.4415
Higaisa	0.4208
WIRTE	0.4157
ZIRCONIUM	0.4157

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator
Domain	noht1ng[.]top
Domain	mail[.]uaiubifas[.]top
Hash	29c7ee41d0cc9e07d981e451df56d0c3d37c41ac4ec10c7b516cc033ee397a63
Hash	749160a2f20f82744026719cf72e483595c6aad718efa74d675a98662e02422e
Hash	d7a3c7eb94edc0e020f74c678743d71d61e944634aade4a67a96c3589e828b3a

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1566.002 Spearphishing Link (initial-access)
- **Observed here:** T1566.002 Spearphishing Link was the initial-access control point; blocking a means-of-entry rarely stops a determined actor, so the pivot projects forward to the execution stage they must still reach.
- **Projected pivot:** T1053 Scheduled Task/Job (execution)
- **Basis:** of the 43+ groups that use Spearphishing Link, this pairing runs 1.3x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

If the spearphishing-link vector is blocked, UNC3569 could still obtain a foothold—perhaps via credential theft or a compromised web service—and then pivot to T1053 Scheduled Task/Job, creating a task that launches its payload at system startup or on a recurring schedule to maintain persistence. Defenders should alert on new scheduled tasks (Event ID 4698), restrict schtasks/at to admins, and baseline legitimate task creators.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1106 Native API (n=18, lift 1.6), T1559 Inter-Process Communication (n=13, lift 1.6)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1053 Scheduled Task/Job)

- **Telemetry:** Windows Security (Object Access audit); Microsoft-Windows-TaskScheduler/Operational; Sysmon
- **Detect:**
 - Security 4698 (task created), 4702 (updated), 4700/4701 (enabled/disabled), 4699 (deleted)
 - TaskScheduler/Operational 106 (registered), 140 (updated), 141 (deleted)
 - Sysmon 1 for schtasks.exe and at.exe; Sysmon 11 for writes under C:\Windows\System32\Tasks\
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict schtasks/at to administrators; disable the legacy at.exe
 - Baseline the legitimate task creators and alert on anything outside it
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1028 Operating System Configuration, M1026 Privileged Account Management · DS0003 Scheduled Job, DS0009 Process, DS0022 File